



Coordinación de
Educación Abierta y a Distancia
VICERRECTORADO ACADÉMICO



First partial exam Group 7
Songkran Water Festival (Thailand)

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Link Video:

<https://youtu.be/vYgiasHcMG8>

Script:**First participation Luis Ordoñez**

Hello teacher. We are Group 7. Today we will present Songkran, the Water Festival from Thailand. It is one of the most unusual celebrations in the world. My name is Luis and with me are Isaac, Roxana, Lenín, Odalys. Let's start."

Second participation Lenín Lopez

Our group is going to take you to Southeast Asia to explore a truly amazing and unusual celebration: the Songkran Water Festival. This fantastic event takes place in Thailand. Local people are used to celebrating this event every year from April 13th to April 15th, to mark the beginning of the traditional Thai New Year.

The most famous part of Songkran is definitely the massive water fights in the streets. People arm themselves with water guns, buckets, and even hoses, transforming the entire country into the world's biggest water park. Since April is the hottest month in Thailand, everyone is used to the extreme heat, so the cold water is incredibly refreshing! However, if you visit, you will quickly have to get used to wearing wet clothes all day long.

But it is not just about throwing water for fun; Songkran has a very deep cultural meaning. The water actually symbolizes washing away bad luck and sins from the previous year. A beautiful, quieter tradition involves pouring gently scented water over Buddha statues and over the hands of elders to show deep respect. Because it is such a unique cultural experience, tourists need to get used to the traditions, joining in both the energetic water fights and the respectful ceremonies.

To add to the festive atmosphere, the streets and temples are beautifully decorated with colorful paper flags and traditional sand pagodas. Also, families are used to cleaning and decorating their homes thoroughly before the festival begins. You will see almost everyone wearing bright, floral-patterned shirts and beautiful flower garlands around their necks. It might seem chaotic at first, but once you get used to the joyful crowds and loud music, it is definitely an unforgettable experience.

Third participation Isaac Cadena

Songkran is a very important festival in Thailand, and it has a long cultural and religious history. It is not only a fun water festival. For Thai people, Songkran is also a special time to start a new year, clean bad things from the past, and spend time with family. In the past, people celebrated Songkran in a more peaceful and spiritual way. Many families went to temples because religion was an important part of the celebration. They did not celebrate only in the streets like many people do today. Families visited temples, cleaned Buddha images, and gave food to monks. The water was very important because it represented purification, respect, and good luck for the new year. This part of the festival was calm and meaningful. Also, people poured water gently on the hands of elderly people to show respect and receive blessings. Before Songkran became famous around the world, Thai families had celebrated it as a traditional and religious event. The festival had not attracted many international tourists before tourism and social media promoted it. Over time, the celebration changed, and people started to celebrate with water fights in the streets. Today, Songkran has two sides. It is still a traditional and spiritual celebration, but it is also a fun public festival with music, tourists, water guns, and many people celebrating together.

Fourth participation Odalys Oleas

Now, let's talk about what could have happened during the Songkran Water Festival. This celebration has a long history, and there are different ideas about how some traditions may have developed over time.

First, the tradition could have started as a way to wash away bad luck and welcome the new year with positive energy. Water has always been an important symbol of purification in many cultures, so people may have used it to represent a fresh start.

Second, some tourists might have misunderstood the true meaning of the festival. Today, many visitors see Songkran as a giant water fight, but originally it was also a religious and family celebration. People visited temples, respected elders, and participated in traditional ceremonies.

Finally, the organizers should have prepared more safety measures in some crowded areas. Every year, millions of people participate in the festival, and large crowds can sometimes cause accidents or transportation problems. Better planning could have helped improve safety for both locals and tourists.

These possibilities help us understand how Songkran has evolved over the years and why it continues to be one of the most famous festivals in Thailand.

Fifth participation Luis Ordoñez

Now, let's imagine a different history for Songkran. What would have happened if things had been different?

If the Thai government had banned people from throwing water in the streets many years ago, young people would have lost interest in the tradition, and maybe the festival would have become very boring and empty.

If international tourists had never visited Thailand during the Songkran dates, the festival would not have become so famous around the world, and many people in other countries would have never heard about this celebration.

If local people had not started using water guns, colorful shirts, and loud music during Songkran, the celebration would have remained only a quiet religious event with small water ceremonies at the temples.

If the older generations had not taught the young people the real meaning of Songkran, which is respect and cleaning bad luck, the water tradition might have disappeared completely, and today nobody would have continued with this custom.

But in reality, the government did not ban the water. Tourists did visit Thailand and they loved the festival. Young people continued the tradition and made it bigger. And the elders taught the new generations. So today, Songkran is a very happy, famous, and unusual celebration.

Sixth participation all

Visiting the Songkran Water Festival must be a unique experience due to its perfect mix of water fights and traditional Thailand culture

In my opinion, Songkran is a very interesting festival because it mixes culture, family, and fun.

I find the Songkran Festival a very beautiful celebration because it blends tradition and fun. It's like Carnival in Ecuador, but with a greater focus on cultural and religious aspects.

Seventh participation Roxana Obando

Let me explain the three types of Songkran festival preparations using causative have and get.

For spiritual preparation, Thai people have food offered to Buddhist monks. They also get the Buddha statues washed with scented water to bring good luck for the new year.

For family preparation, younger people get their hands poured with water by their elders. This is a symbol of respect and purification. Families also have their houses cleaned before the festival.

And Finally for festive preparation, the community gets the streets decorated with colorful flags and garlands. In Bangkok, people have water guns and buckets ready for the water battles. In Ayutthaya, they have a Miss Songkran parade organized.

In conclusion, Songkran is a unique festival that combines spiritual traditions, family respect, and water battles. Thai people are used to celebrating it every April. We wish we could attend someday. Thank you for listening and watching.